HAZEM AMEEN | ANSWER TO THE RIDDLE OF WHITE PLUME MOUNTAIN: THE MOON

> Round she is, yet flat as a board
> Altar of the Lupine Lords
> Jewel on black velvet, pearl in the sea
> Unchanged but e'erchanging eternally
>
> —Riddle of White Plume Mountain

Sphinxes

Collectors and Keepers of Secrets

Habitat: Desert, Planar (Upper Planes); **Treasure:** Arcana

Sphinxes protect the secrets of the multiverse. Formed from the spirits of sages and explorers, sphinxes know the power of truth and the importance of preserving it. They share their wisdom only with those who prove themselves wise or overcome tests of worthiness, such as riddles or battles with dangerous beasts. Through their existences, sphinxes might change form as they gain more nuanced understanding of cosmic enigmas.

Sphinx of Wonder

A sphinx of wonder is brightly feathered and the size of a lion cub. One comes into being every time a unique idea is conceived on the Material Plane. Each sphinx of wonder is fascinated by a particular type of story or field of study, and it learns all it can about that topic. It bears a unique sigil on its forehead that suggests the type of knowledge that fascinates it. Sometimes, a sphinx of wonder forms a bond with a mortal scholar and aids them in their research.

Sphinx of Wonder

Tiny Celestial, Lawful Good

AC 13 **Initiative** +3 (13)
HP 24 (7d4 + 7)
Speed 20 ft., Fly 40 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	6	−2	−2	**Dex**	17	+3	+3	**Con**	13	+1	+1
Int	15	+2	+2	**Wis**	12	+1	+1	**Cha**	11	+0	+0

Skills Arcana +4, Religion +4, Stealth +5
Resistances Necrotic, Psychic, Radiant
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 11
Languages Celestial, Common
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Traits

Magic Resistance. The sphinx has Advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Actions

Rend. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) Slashing damage plus 7 (2d6) Radiant damage.

Reactions

Burst of Ingenuity (2/Day). *Trigger:* The sphinx or another creature within 30 feet makes an ability check or a saving throw. *Response:* The sphinx adds 2 to the roll.

Sphinx of Secrets

Large Celestial, Lawful Neutral

AC 16 **Initiative** +5 (15)
HP 136 (16d10 + 48)
Speed 40 ft., Fly 60 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	18	+4	+4	**Dex**	15	+2	+2	**Con**	16	+3	+3
Int	18	+4	+4	**Wis**	18	+4	+4	**Cha**	18	+4	+4

Skills History +7, Perception +7, Religion +7
Resistances Necrotic, Radiant
Immunities Psychic; Charmed, Frightened
Senses Truesight 60 ft.; Passive Perception 17
Languages Celestial, Common
CR 8 (XP 3,900; PB +3)

Traits

Inscrutable. No magic can observe the sphinx remotely or detect its thoughts without its permission. Wisdom (Insight) checks made to ascertain its intentions or sincerity are made with Disadvantage.

Magic Resistance. The sphinx has Advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Actions

Multiattack. The sphinx makes three Claw attacks. It can replace one attack with a use of Curse of the Riddle.

Claw. *Melee Attack Roll:* +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) Slashing damage plus 7 (2d6) Radiant damage.

Curse of the Riddle. *Intelligence Saving Throw:* DC 15, one creature the sphinx can see within 60 feet. *Failure:* 21 (6d6) Psychic damage, and the target is cursed with a riddle. The cursed target has Disadvantage on ability checks and attack rolls. In addition, if it takes the Magic action, it must succeed on a DC 15 Intelligence saving throw or that action is wasted. The cursed target can take a Study action to make a DC 15 Intelligence check, solving the riddle and ending the curse on a success. The curse ends early if the sphinx curses another target.

Spellcasting. The sphinx casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 15):

At Will: *Detect Magic, Identify, Prestidigitation*
1/Day Each: *Locate Object, Remove Curse*

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Sphinx of Secrets

Sphinxes of secrets are commonly associated with a site of great magic or learning. These immortal beings often outlive such locations, though, and might protect a site's ruins as they continue their own studies. Sphinxes of secrets fiercely guard their dwellings and research.

Sphinx of Lore

Sphinxes of lore each know a great secret and protect it all costs. This truth might take the form of an ancient text, a magical puzzle, or a path to another world. These sphinxes might gain reputations as sages or oracles, but they typically dwell far from civilization.

Sphinx of Valor

Sphinxes of valor guard world-changing or dangerous secrets—evidence of weird truths, deadly Artifacts, and things that shouldn't exist. They inhabit hidden, magical sites and hold their duty above mortal life. If threatened, a sphinx of valor defends its charge with its supernaturally empowered roar and fierce strikes.

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Sphinx of Lore

Large Celestial, Lawful Neutral

AC 17 **Initiative** +10 (20)
HP 170 (20d10 + 60)
Speed 40 ft., Fly 60 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	18	+4	+4	**Dex**	15	+2	+2	**Con**	16	+3	+3
Int	18	+4	+4	**Wis**	18	+4	+4	**Cha**	18	+4	+4

Skills Arcana +12, History +12, Perception +8, Religion +12
Resistances Necrotic, Radiant
Immunities Psychic; Charmed, Frightened
Senses Truesight 120 ft.; Passive Perception 18
Languages Celestial, Common
CR 11 (XP 7,200, or 8,400 in lair; PB +4)

Traits

Inscrutable. No magic can observe the sphinx remotely or detect its thoughts without its permission. Wisdom (Insight) checks made to ascertain its intentions or sincerity are made with Disadvantage.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the sphinx fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Actions

Multiattack. The sphinx makes three Claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Attack Roll:* +8, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 14 (3d6 + 4) Slashing damage.

Mind-Rending Roar (Recharge 5–6). *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 16, each enemy in a 300-foot Emanation originating from the sphinx. *Failure:* 35 (10d6) Psychic damage, and the target has the Incapacitated condition until the start of the sphinx's next turn.

Spellcasting. The sphinx casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 16):

At Will: *Detect Magic, Identify, Mage Hand, Minor Illusion, Prestidigitation*
1/Day Each: *Dispel Magic, Legend Lore, Locate Object, Plane Shift, Remove Curse, Tongues*

Legendary Actions

Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the sphinx can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The sphinx regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

Arcane Prowl. The sphinx can teleport up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space it can see, and it makes one Claw attack.

Weight of Years. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 16, one creature the sphinx can see within 120 feet. *Failure:* The target gains 1 Exhaustion level. While the target has any Exhaustion levels, it appears 3d10 years older. *Failure or Success:* The sphinx can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

Sphinx Lairs

Sphinxes typically dwell in places that hold great knowledge or prophetic magic.

The region containing a sphinx of lore's or sphinx of valor's lair is altered by its presence, creating the following effects:

Distant Sight. While in its lair, the sphinx can cast *Clairvoyance*, requiring no spell components and using the same spellcasting ability as its Spellcasting action. When cast this way, the spell's range is 1 mile.

Infusion of Knowledge. Whenever the sphinx or one of its allies takes a Study action while within 1 mile of the lair, it adds 1d6 to any ability check it makes for that action.

If the sphinx dies or moves its lair elsewhere, these effects end immediately.

Sphinx of Valor

Large Celestial, Lawful Neutral

AC 17 **Initiative** +12 (22)
HP 199 (19d10 + 95)
Speed 40 ft., Fly 60 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	22	+6	+6	**Dex**	10	+0	+6	**Con**	20	+5	+11
Int	16	+3	+9	**Wis**	23	+6	+12	**Cha**	18	+4	+4

Skills Arcana +9, Perception +12, Religion +15
Resistances Necrotic, Radiant
Immunities Psychic; Charmed, Frightened
Senses Truesight 120 ft.; Passive Perception 22
Languages Celestial, Common
CR 17 (XP 18,000, or 20,000 in lair; PB +6)

Traits

Inscrutable. No magic can observe the sphinx remotely or detect its thoughts without its permission. Wisdom (Insight) checks made to ascertain its intentions or sincerity are made with Disadvantage.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day, or 4/Day in Lair). If the sphinx fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Actions

Multiattack. The sphinx makes two Claw attacks and uses Roar.

Claw. *Melee Attack Roll:* +12, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 20 (4d6 + 6) Slashing damage.

Roar (3/Day). The sphinx emits a magical roar. Whenever it roars, the roar has a different effect, as detailed below (the sequence resets when it takes a Long Rest):

First Roar. *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 20, each enemy in a 500-foot Emanation originating from the sphinx. *Failure:* The target has the Frightened condition for 1 minute.

Second Roar. *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 20, each enemy in a 500-foot Emanation originating from the sphinx. *Failure:* The target has the Paralyzed condition, and it repeats the save at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. After 1 minute, it succeeds automatically.

Third Roar. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 20, each enemy in a 500-foot Emanation originating from the sphinx. *Failure:* 44 (8d10) Thunder damage, and the target has the Prone condition. *Success:* Half damage only.

Spellcasting. The sphinx casts one of the following spells, requiring no Material components and using Wisdom as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 20):

At Will: *Detect Evil and Good, Thaumaturgy*
1/Day Each: *Detect Magic, Dispel Magic, Greater Restoration, Heroes' Feast, Zone of Truth*

Legendary Actions

Legendary Action Uses: 3 (4 in Lair). Immediately after another creature's turn, the sphinx can expend a use to take one of the following actions. The sphinx regains all expended uses at the start of each of its turns.

Arcane Prowl. The sphinx can teleport up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space it can see, and it makes one Claw attack.

Weight of Years. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 16, one creature the sphinx can see within 120 feet. *Failure:* The target gains 1 Exhaustion level. While the target has any Exhaustion levels, it appears 3d10 years older. *Failure or Success:* The sphinx can't take this action again until the start of its next turn.

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